

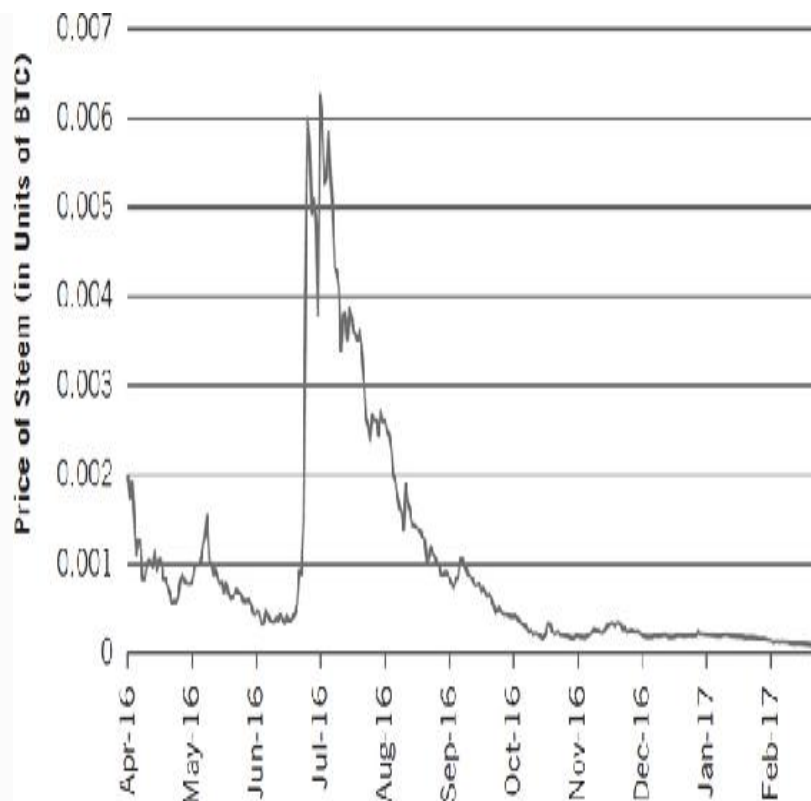


Figure 10.4 ■ Steemit's speculation-fueled price bubble
Data sourced from CryptoCompare

The Zcash Bubble

One of the most meteoric rises and crashes was the October 2016 rollout of the new privacy-focused cryptocurrency zcash (ZEC). Few cryptocurrencies have been more anticipated than this one, and rightfully so, given its strong engineering team. Ethereum's Vitalik Buterin was an advisor and described Zcash as providing the "advantages of using a public blockchain, while still being sure that their private information is protected."²¹ Two well-regarded cryptoasset investment firms, Pantera Capital and Digital Currency Group, were involved with Zcash as well. Zcash technology targeted the